I had somewhat similar experience during the raid on drug traffickers in the UP hills when I was with the Narcotics Bureau. What I want to point out – and this has been my stance during the lawyers' agitation too – is that I have never been cowed down, or accepted defeat or tolerated injustice in my over 20 years of service. So why should I bow to a totally absurd demand made by the Mizoram chief minister now? People have often wondered how I, being a woman, can combat certain things. My answer to all of them [has] been, that it is wrong to think that just because a certain person is a woman, she is delicate. I am not delicate – maybe that's why one does not get to see me in a saree – I feel the saree is for delicate people.

Anyway, in the context of the present situation, the ongoing controversy about me and my daughter, Sukriti [as Saina was then called], I'd say that we are absolutely in the right. My daughter gets the seat for two factors. One, that she is the daughter of an IPS officer who is serving on a 'hard area' posting, and as per the Central Government guidelines, the children of such officers are entitled to certain benefits. But this is the secondary factor in Sukriti's case. She got the seat on her own merit … getting the highest marks among students who took the exams from Mizoram. Now what I'd like to add here is that I did not ask the government to give me a posting [specifically] in Mizoram, the government wanted my services there. Since my daughter stays with me, she went to Mizoram too with me, and studied in the Central School there for two years. So now that she has studied there, why should she take the exams elsewhere? The chief minister says that he does not want non-Mizos to get seats from Mizoram because they are not going to return to the state. I ask him, what gave him the idea that they are not going to return? All the other four non-Mizo candidates who were selected – all on merit – are children of people who are integral part of Mizoram. One student's father has been a civil servant in the Mizo government for almost two decades and is going to retire in the same capacity, another's father is a doctor there, the third student's mother is a Mizo woman … I ask where will the children of these people go? After all, they are a product of the place. I am fighting on this issue because if this is allowed to go unprotested, tomorrow nobody will be willing to go and serve in Mizoram, and then some time later other states too might follow suit. This would be a big blow to our country's unity, national integration, democracy and all that we stand for. I wonder how a state government can bow to such unjust and discriminatory demands.

For that matter, what guarantee does Mr Lal Thanhawla have that the Mizo students who do their MBBS are going to serve in Mizoram? Have all the Mizo students returned to the state in the past? Can they be compelled to do so? India after all is a democracy, not a dictatorship – you cannot curb a citizen's freedom to go and work wherever he feels like, so what is the big point? And besides, the seats of doctors in the state are not vacant because of want of availability of doctors. If the chief minister says so, I challenge him to prove it.

The third question I'd like to ask is, what if tomorrow the same treatment is meted out to Mizos in Delhi? What if they are told that they will not be considered under the scheduled caste or scheduled tribe category in Delhi, and so they should return to their states and apply under the special slot there? Well, don't misunderstand me. I don't want that to happen. I am not a Mizo or non-Mizo, a Hindu, Sikh, or Delhiite – I am an Indian, and I look upon every individual in India as an equal, so whatever happened has hurt me extremely. I have become a victim of an anti-Indian, anti-national feeling. Till my actions, like controlling the drug problem there, has [*sic*] benefited the society there, I was accepted, but the moment matters came to Mizo–non-Mizo sentiments, I was made to feel that I was an outsider.

I was asked in writing to meet the chief minister and discuss this issue with him in the evening